RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

15 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 9:55 AM, Thursday 15 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 194 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Operating** · 62 cancelled

Riyadh halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, about 5,070 minutes at 10:00 AM; Dammam traffic moving after halt 5:14–6:59 AM; NOTAM A3604/26 to 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, about 5,070 minutes at 10:00 AM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 194 flights cancelled for Thursday (26% of scheduled).
- Coalition intercepted and destroyed a drone over the Eastern Region (CONFIRMED, SPA / Al Ekhbariya) — no newer attack or Civil Defense alert since then.
- Dammam traffic moving after halt 5:14–6:59 AM; takeoffs resumed 7:02 AM; 62 flights cancelled today.
- SPA: oil prices fall as investors assess supply outlook (CONFIRMED).

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (5066 min).

194	0/0	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

OPERATING

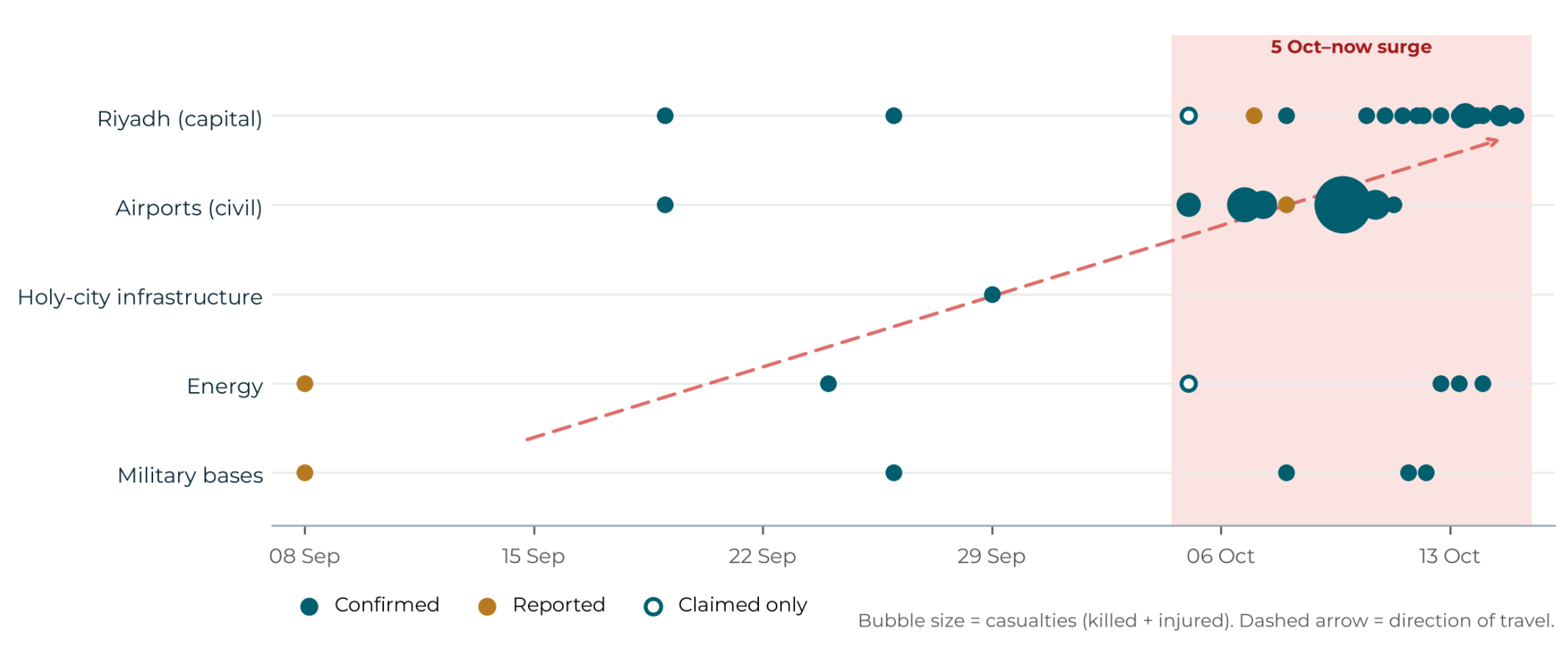
3 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour.

62	3/2	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (4,950 min at 8:00 AM). Dammam reopened after the 5:14–6:59 AM halt: SV118 landed 6:59 AM, SV1127 took off 7:02 AM; last hour had multiple Dammam takeoffs. No new attack, interception or Civil Defense alert from official Saudi accounts since the Eastern Region drone intercept (~4:13–5:59 AM).

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 15 OCT



38 sourced events since 8 September (32 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: UAV intercepted and destroyed in Eastern Region (4:13 AM) (15 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

2 Riyadh still halted; Dammam moving after 5:14–6:59 AM halt; no new official attack reports since Eastern Region drone

Checked at 9:55 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Coalition intercepted and destroyed a drone over the Eastern Region**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:59 AM** · published 5:59 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya relayed the coalition statement that a drone was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region. No casualties reported in the coalition line.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **4:13 AM** · published 4:13 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition spokesman, Arabic; SPA English 4:43 AM); checked 6:50 AM

The Coalition spokesman said a drone (UAV) was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region; first posted in Arabic at 4:13 AM by the Coalition spokesman and SPA, English release from SPA at 4:43 AM. No casualties or debris damage reported so far.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces say about 1,250 Houthi fighters neutralised and more than 460 militia vehicles destroyed**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:35 AM** · published 2:35 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's armed forces said about 1,250 Houthi fighters had been neutralised and more than 460 militia military vehicles destroyed; the figures are the Yemeni forces' own and were not independently verified. No new attack, interception, Civil Defense alert or airport statement was posted by official Saudi accounts between 2:00 and 3:00 AM.

CONFIRMED **Islamic Affairs Minister praises the armed forces' sacrifices in protecting the Kingdom**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:45 AM** · published 1:45 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Minister of Islamic Affairs Sheikh Dr. Abdullatif Al-Sheikh said the Kingdom will remain a nation of monotheism and pure creed, and that it values the great sacrifices of the armed forces in protecting the homeland. No new attack, interception or airport statement was posted by official Saudi accounts between 1:00 and 2:00 AM.

CONFIRMED **Saudi UN envoy in Geneva: Kingdom condemns repeated Houthi attacks and affirms its right to protect its sovereignty**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:34 AM** · published 12:34 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Abdulmohsen bin Khuthaila, the Kingdom's permanent representative to the UN in Geneva, said Saudi Arabia condemns the Houthi terrorist militia's repeated attacks on its territory and affirms its right to protect its sovereignty and the security of citizens and residents under international law.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya correspondent in Yemen: 'Dawn of Yemen' operation escalating on Taiz, Marib and Lahj fronts**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:25 AM** · published 12:25 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Saudi state broadcaster Al Ekhbariya's Yemen correspondent reported the 'Dawn of Yemen' operation is escalating quickly, with 24 hours of fighting on the northern and western fronts of Taiz city. He said the Houthi militia fired more than 1,000 mortar rounds at Jabal Han in 24 hours without a breakthrough. Battlefield claims are not independently verified.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport (KKIA) tells passengers to check flight status with their airline**
King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **12:24 AM** · published 12:24 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account reply, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Replying to a passenger, King Khalid International Airport said that for flight status or any updates, travellers should contact their airline, as the carrier is responsible for the flight. No reopening time was given.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Bahrain condemns Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and urges decisive Security Council measures**
SPA (@Spa_Eng, @SPAregions) · **11:56 PM Wed** · published 11:56 PM AST Wed 14 Oct (SPA English; Arabic 10:20 PM); checked 12:58 AM

The Saudi Press Agency reported that Bahrain strongly condemned the Houthi terrorist militia's attacks on Saudi Arabia and urged the UN Security Council to take decisive measures. It adds to the string of foreign condemnations carried by SPA since the airport strikes.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: separation surgery for Fiji twins Daisasia and Jessie Bailey begins in Riyadh**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:47 AM** · published 7:47 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 7:55 AM

Al Ekhbariya correspondent Mansour Al-Amir reported that separation surgery for twins Daisasia and Jessie Bailey from Fiji was about to begin in Riyadh, with 34 medical staff and an expected duration of about 15 hours. Unrelated to airport or attack developments.

CONFIRMED **SPA: thunderstorms and flood risk forecast for southwest and western regions**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **7:00 AM** · published 7:00 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 7:55 AM

SPA carried a National Center for Meteorology outlook for moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash floods, hail and active winds over Jazan, Asir, Al-Baha and Makkah, and lighter to moderate rain over Medina, Hail, Tabuk, Al-Jouf, the Northern Borders and the Eastern Region. No airport closure linked to weather in the bulletin.

CONFIRMED **Saudi embassy in Bahrain helping citizens with disrupted flights get home, including by road**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:15 AM** · published 5:15 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported ongoing efforts by the Saudi embassy in Bahrain to help Saudi citizens whose flights were affected return home, including arranging land transport.

CONFIRMED **SPA: oil prices fall as investors assess supply outlook**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **6:51 AM** · published 6:51 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (SPA English); checked 7:55 AM

SPA English reported that oil prices fell as investors assessed the supply outlook. No new official link in the post to Red Sea or Hormuz transit disruption.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

3 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (5066 min).

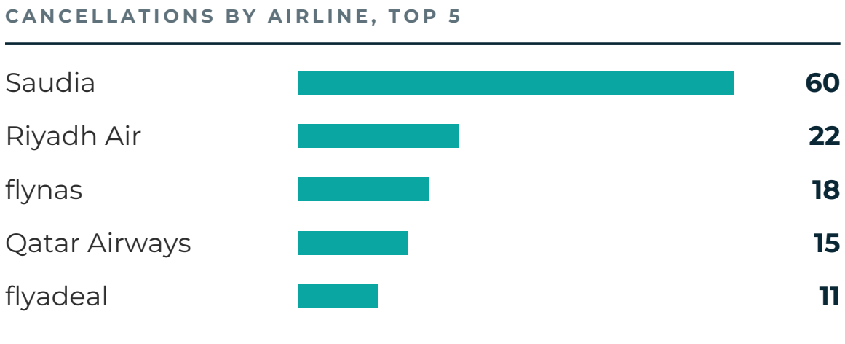
194	4:11 AM	—	0	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
89 departures + 105 arrivals, 26% of 749 scheduled.	SV1523 to Tabuk, 1784 min before 9:55 AM.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Qassim.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 9:55 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 194 at 9:56 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

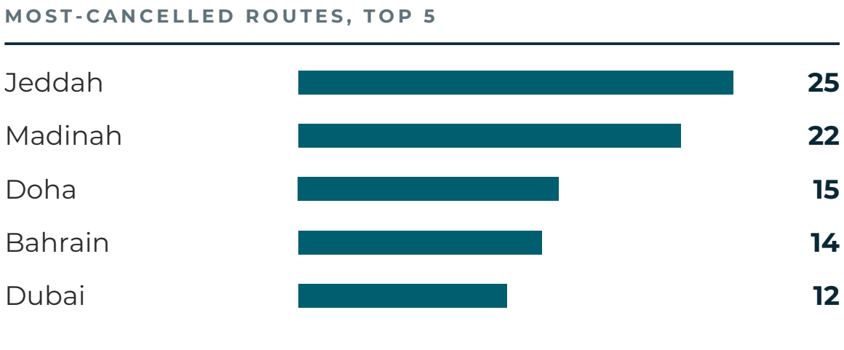
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	89	105	194	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	89 (24%)	105 (28%)	194	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	1 (0%)	0 (0%)	1	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	3 (75%)	23 (100%)	26	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 125	0 of 106	0 of 231	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	1	1	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	12	18	30	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	236	217	453	FR24 stats panel

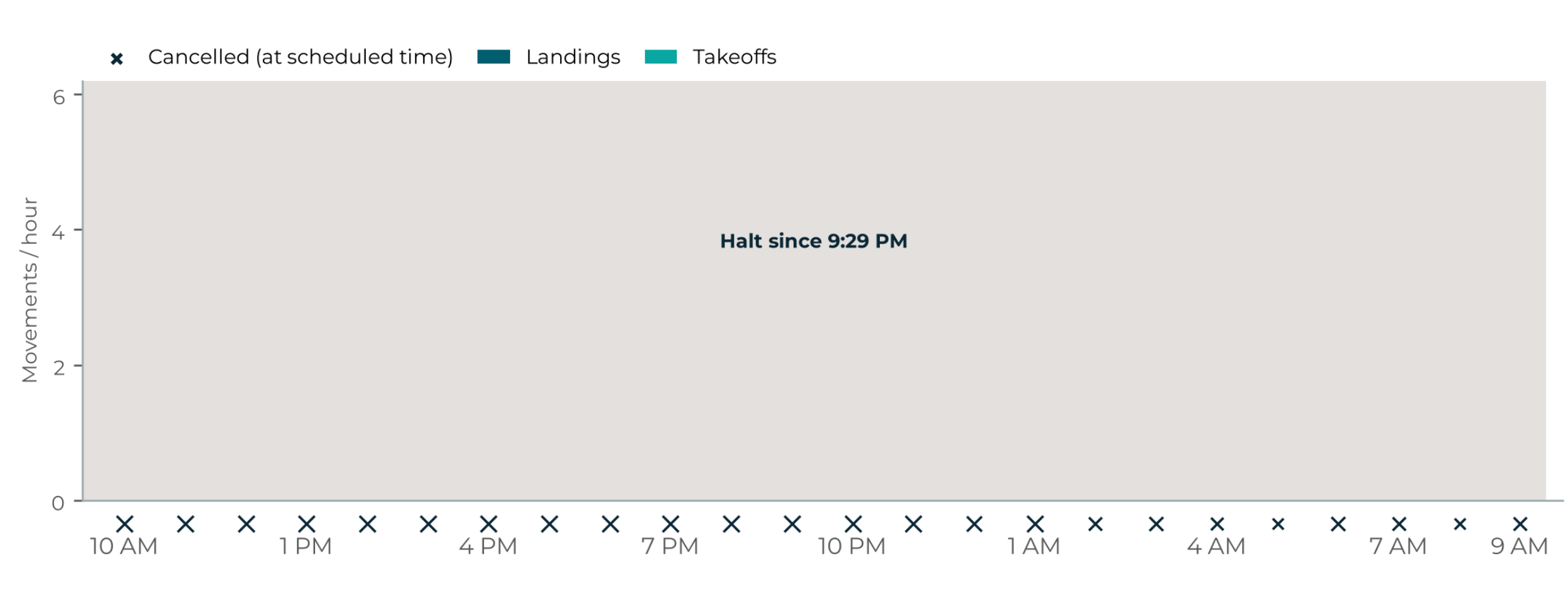
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



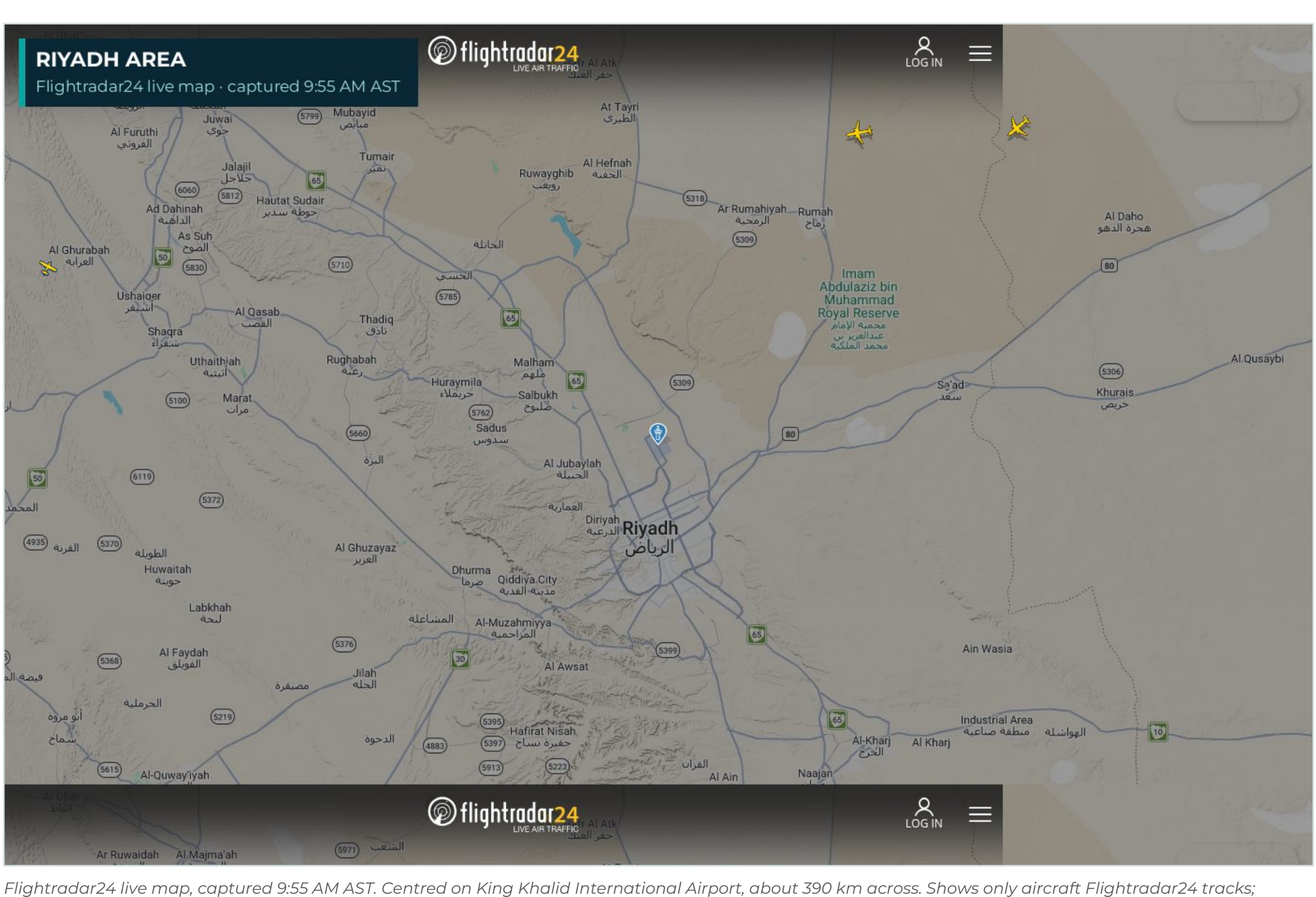
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 10:00 AM Wednesday to 9:55 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movement in it was SV1523 to Tabuk at 4:11 AM Wednesday. Dammam's 5:14–6:59 AM halt closed when SV118 landed.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	5066 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA


RIYADH AREA
Flightradar24 live map · captured 9:55 AM AST
flightradar24
LOG IN
Riyadh
Imam Abdulaziz bin Muhammad Royal Reserve

Flightradar24 live map, captured 9:55 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

4 Dammam airport: operating. 3 takeoffs and 2 landings in the last hour.

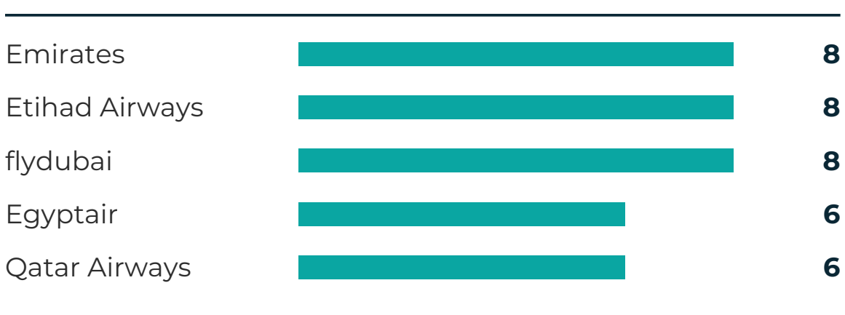
62	9:40 AM	9:38 AM	3	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
30 departures + 32 arrivals, 22% of 284 scheduled.	XY403 to Jeddah, 15 min before 9:55 AM.	F3303 from Jeddah, 17 min before 9:55 AM.	2 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Madinah.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 9:55 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 62 at 9:56 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

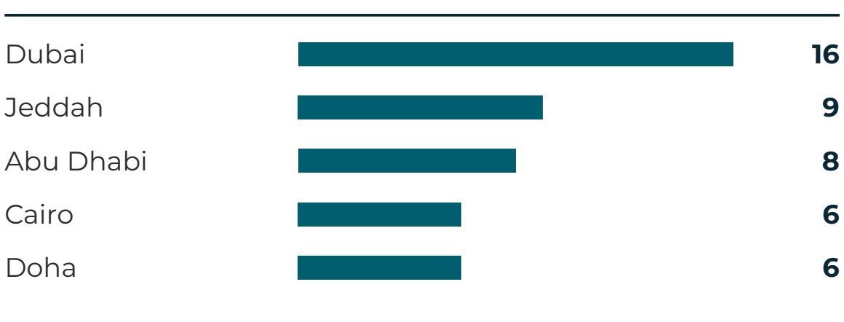
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	30	32	62	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	30 (21%)	32 (22%)	62	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	8 (6%)	6 (4%)	14	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	4 (33%)	8 (57%)	12	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	6 min	16 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	17 of 39	16 of 37	33 of 76	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	1	1	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	14	14	28	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	45	43	88	FR24 stats panel

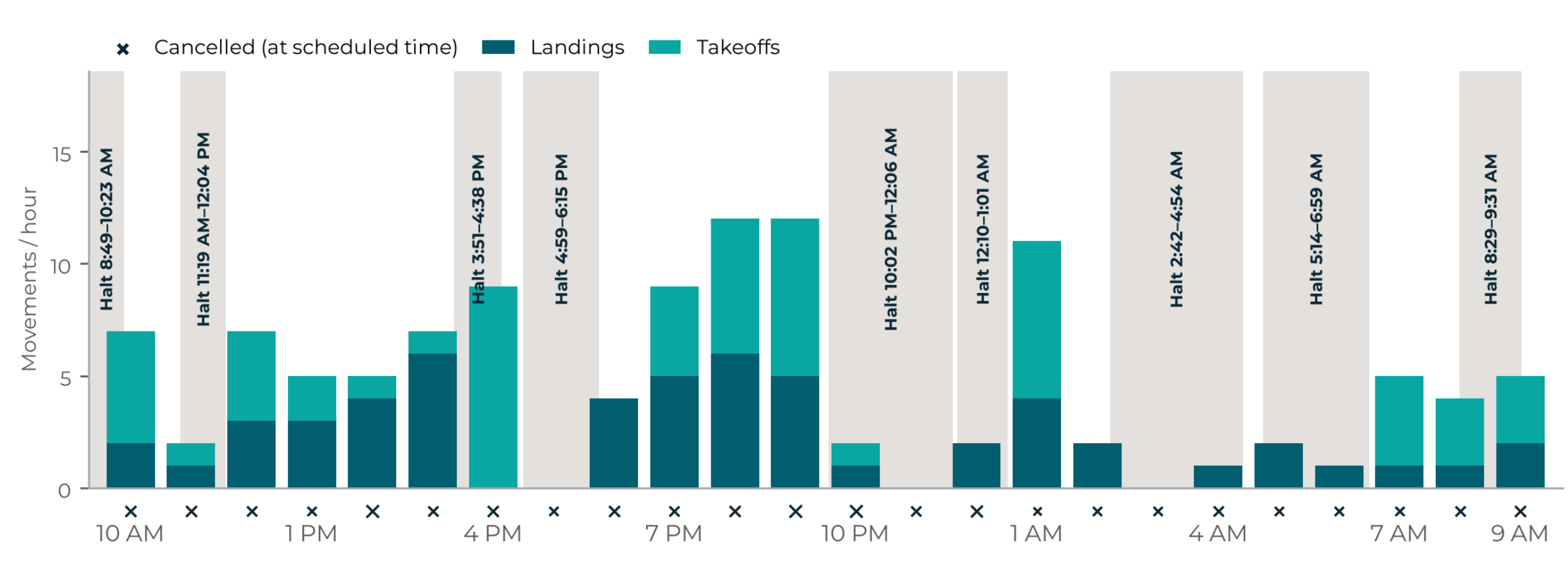
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (58) and landings (56) at DMM per hour from 10:00 AM Wednesday to 9:55 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

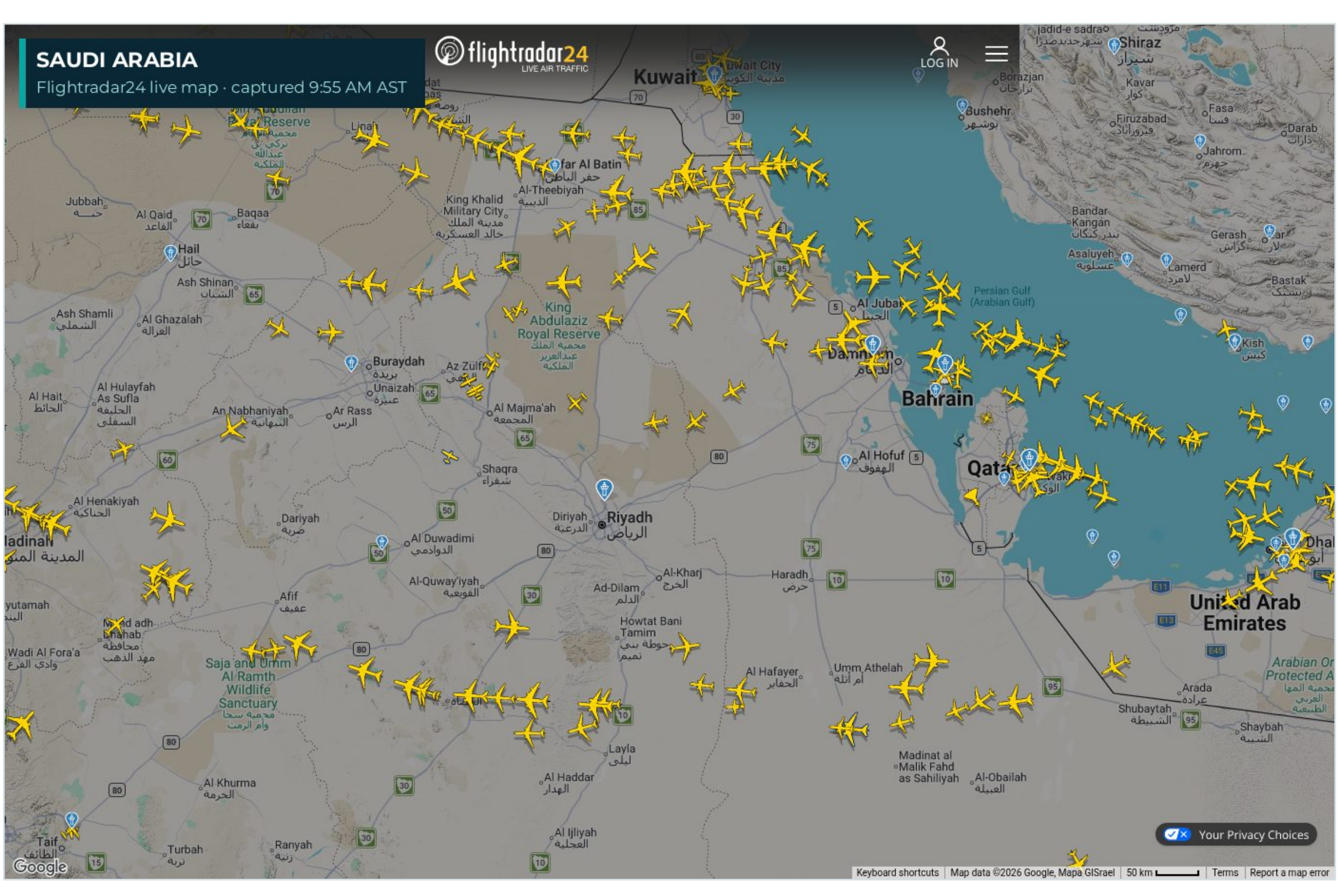
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 8:29–9:31 AM	62 min
Halt 5:14–6:59 AM	105 min
Halt 2:42–4:54 AM	132 min
Halt 12:10–1:01 AM	50 min
Halt 10:02 PM–12:06 AM	123 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (9:55 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



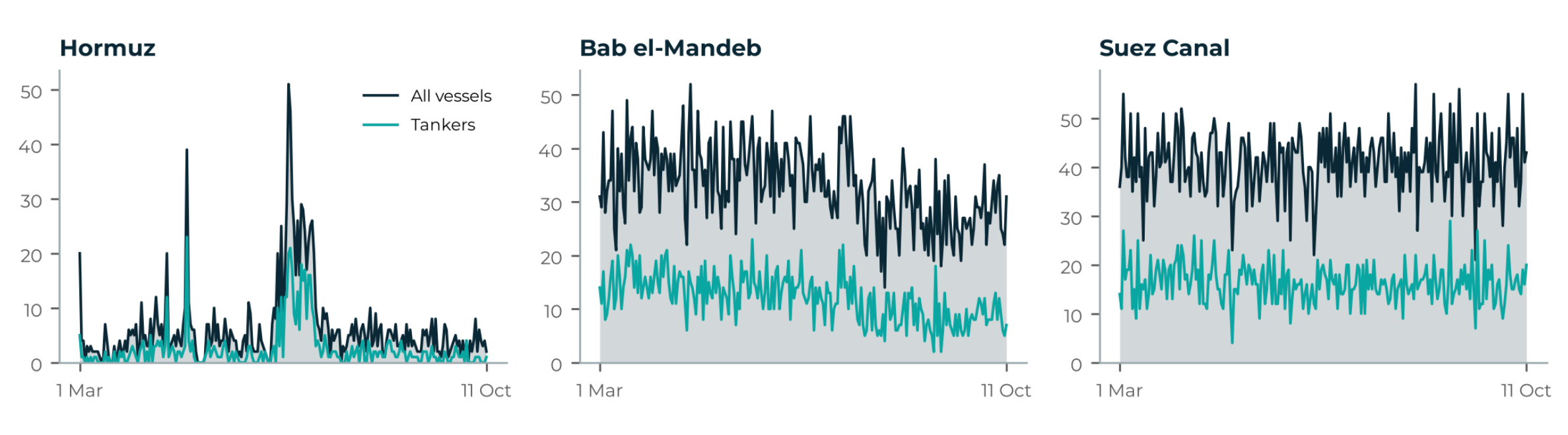
Flightradar24 live map, captured 9:55 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

5 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

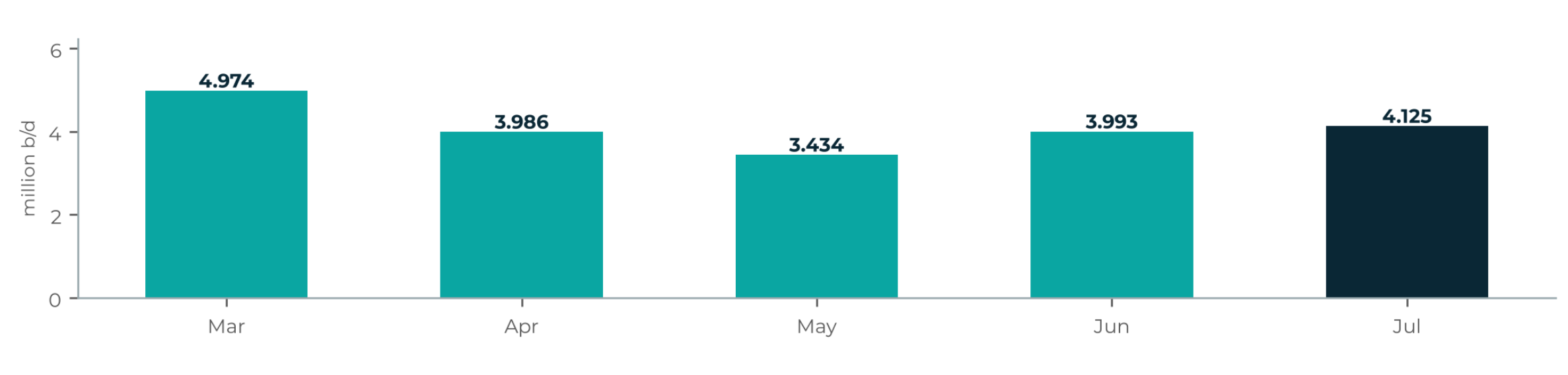
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 9:56 AM, Thu 15 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

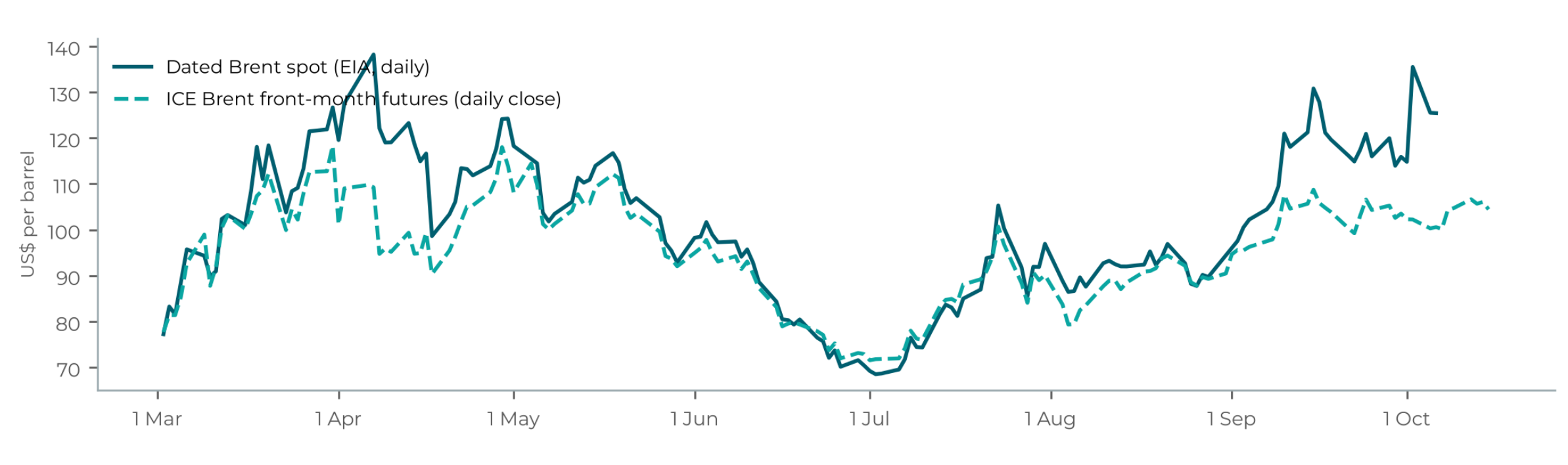


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$104.46	$125.44	+23%	+62%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 9:46 AM, Thu 15 Oct AST (-1.5% on day). Near real time.	Tue 6 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $102.24 on Fri 4 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

6 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 9:55 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
9:55 AM, Thu 15 Oct	9:55 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Operating**	Open sources · not official	11:00 AM